Women's Specialists of Clear Lake
Geffrey H. Klein, MD · FACOG · DABOM

400 W Medical Center Blvd, Suite 300
Webster, Texas 77598 · (281) 557-0300

Contrave® for Weight Management

Naltrexone / Bupropion extended-release — prescription weight management medication

HOW CONTRAVE WORKS

Contrave combines two medications that work together on two key brain pathways to reduce hunger and cravings:

Naltrexone
Opioid antagonist — blocks reward responses to food, reducing cravings and compulsive eating

Bupropion
Antidepressant — acts on hypothalamus to reduce hunger; boosts dopamine to reduce cravings

Expected weight loss: 5–10% of initial body weight when combined with diet and exercise.

May Be Most Beneficial For:

- Food cravings and reward-driven eating
- Emotional or stress eating patterns
- Patients who struggle with binge eating urges

DOSING SCHEDULE

4-Week Titration Schedule

Week 1:1 tab AM 8mg naltrexone / 90mg bupropion
Week 2:1 tab AM + 1 tab PM Morning & evening
Week 3:2 tabs AM + 1 tab PM Increased morning dose
Week 4+:2 tabs AM + 2 tabs PM Full dose = 32mg/360mg daily

Take with food. Do NOT take with a high-fat meal (may increase bupropion side effects). Swallow whole — do not crush or chew.

COMMON SIDE EFFECTS

Most Common (usually improve with time):

- Nausea (most common — improves after 4 weeks)
- Constipation, headache, vomiting
- Dizziness, insomnia, dry mouth
- Increased heart rate or blood pressure

Serious Side Effects — Call Us Immediately:

- Seizures — STOP medication and call 911
- Thoughts of suicide or self-harm
- Severe liver damage (jaundice, dark urine)
- Manic episode or severe mood changes
- Severe allergic reaction

FDA Black Box Warning: Increased risk of suicidal thoughts in patients under 24. Report mood changes immediately.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Do NOT Take Contrave If You Have:

- Uncontrolled high blood pressure
- Seizure disorder or history of seizures
- Currently using opioid pain medications
- Eating disorder (anorexia or bulimia)
- Withdrawing from alcohol, benzodiazepines, or barbiturates
- Taken an MAOI within the last 14 days
- Pregnancy or planning to become pregnant
- Known allergy to naltrexone or bupropion

Important Drug Interactions:

- Opioid pain medications (blocks effect + risk of withdrawal)
- MAO inhibitors (serious risk)
- Dopaminergic drugs, anti-seizure medications

Contrave Works Best As Part of a Comprehensive Plan

Contrave is not a stand-alone treatment. Maximum results come from combining medication with a reduced-calorie diet, regular physical activity, and behavioral support. Questions? Call us at
(281) 557-0300
.